

Where Should the Next Startup Actually Get Built?

A pattern analysis of 1,000 live startups on TrustMRR — revenue, growth, and category economics, frozen 30 Jul 2026.



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WHY THIS EXERCISE

Counting startups is easy. Finding where the money actually is — isn't.

1,000 rows of revenue, growth, and category data can turn into a spreadsheet of trivia, or into a decision. The job here isn't to summarize the dataset — it's to find the gap between where founders are building and where the revenue actually sits, and argue for where the next one should build.

1,000

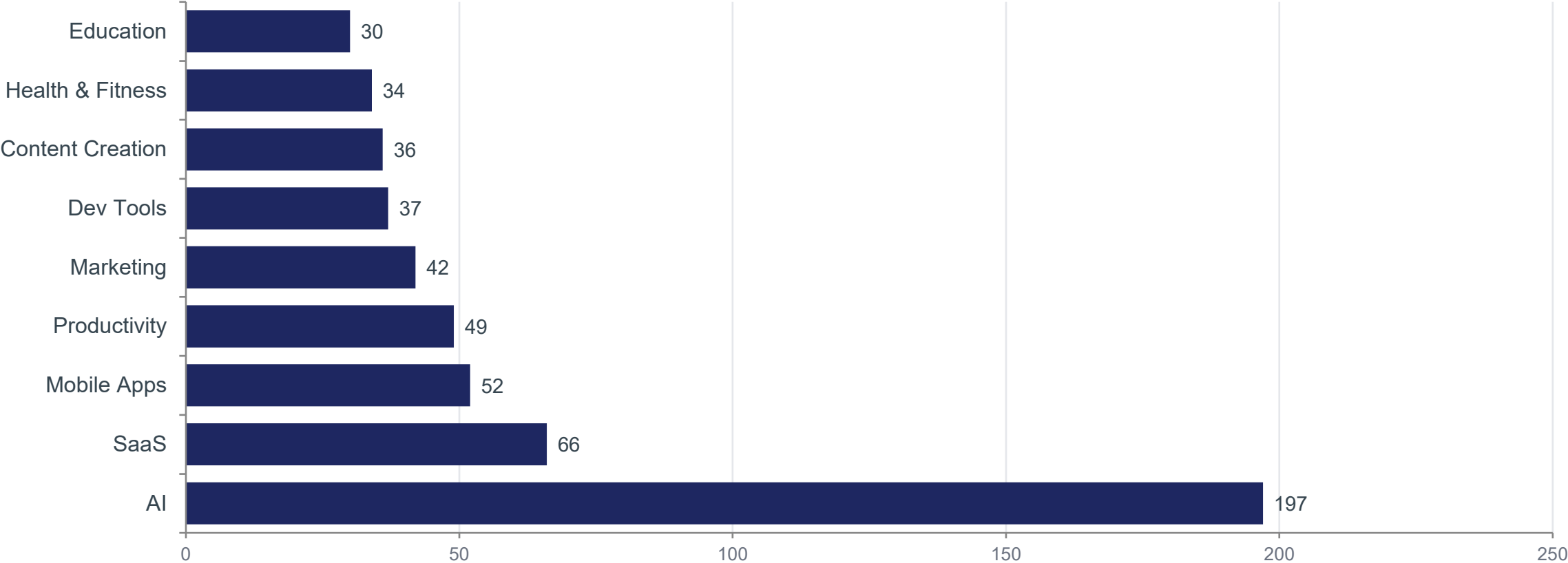
live startups analyzed

\$13.47M

combined monthly recurring revenue

Everyone is building in the same three rooms

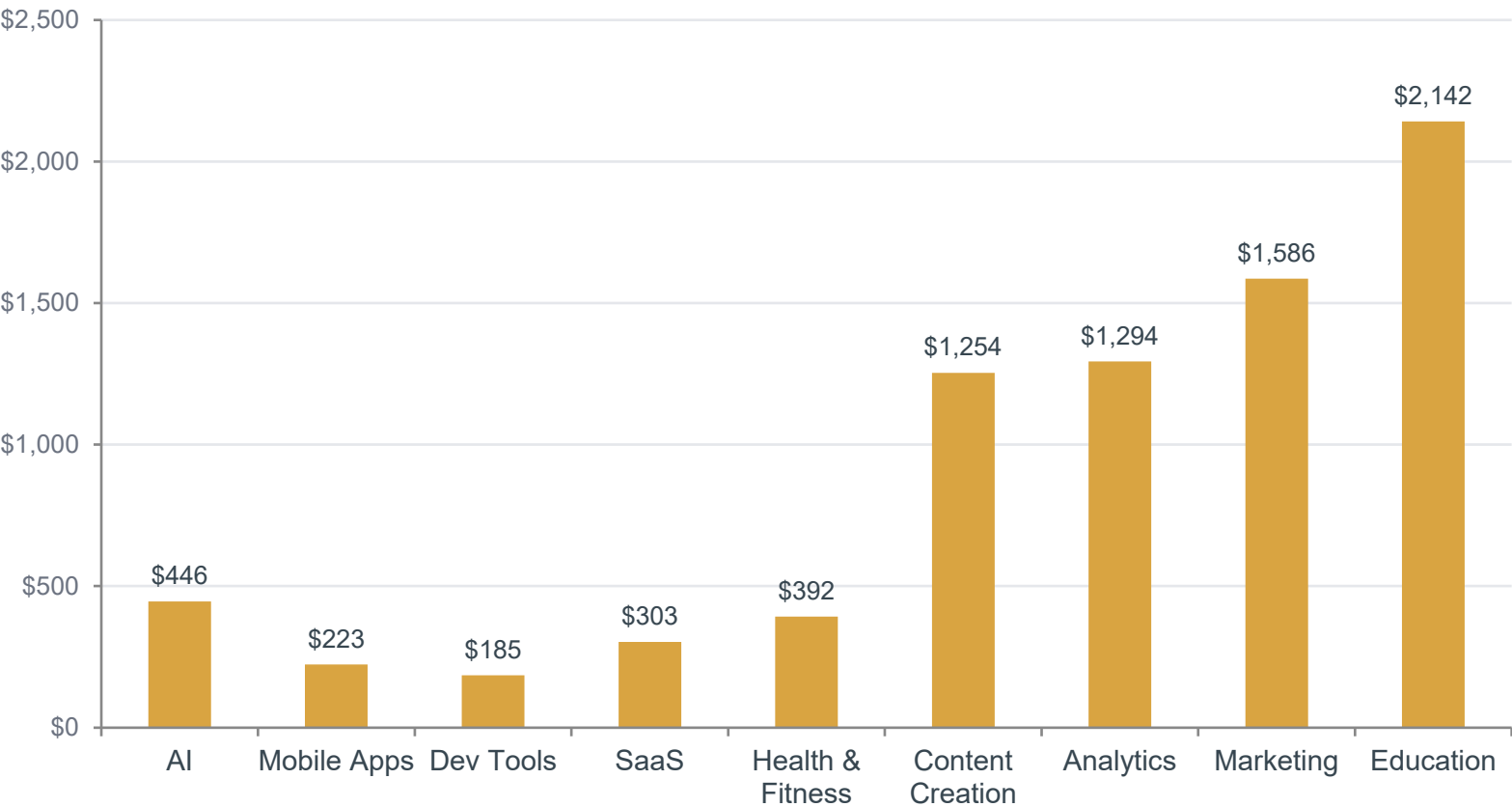
Startup count by category — this is a crowding map, not a leaderboard.



THE REVEAL

Volume and revenue point in opposite directions

Median monthly recurring revenue per startup, by category (USD).



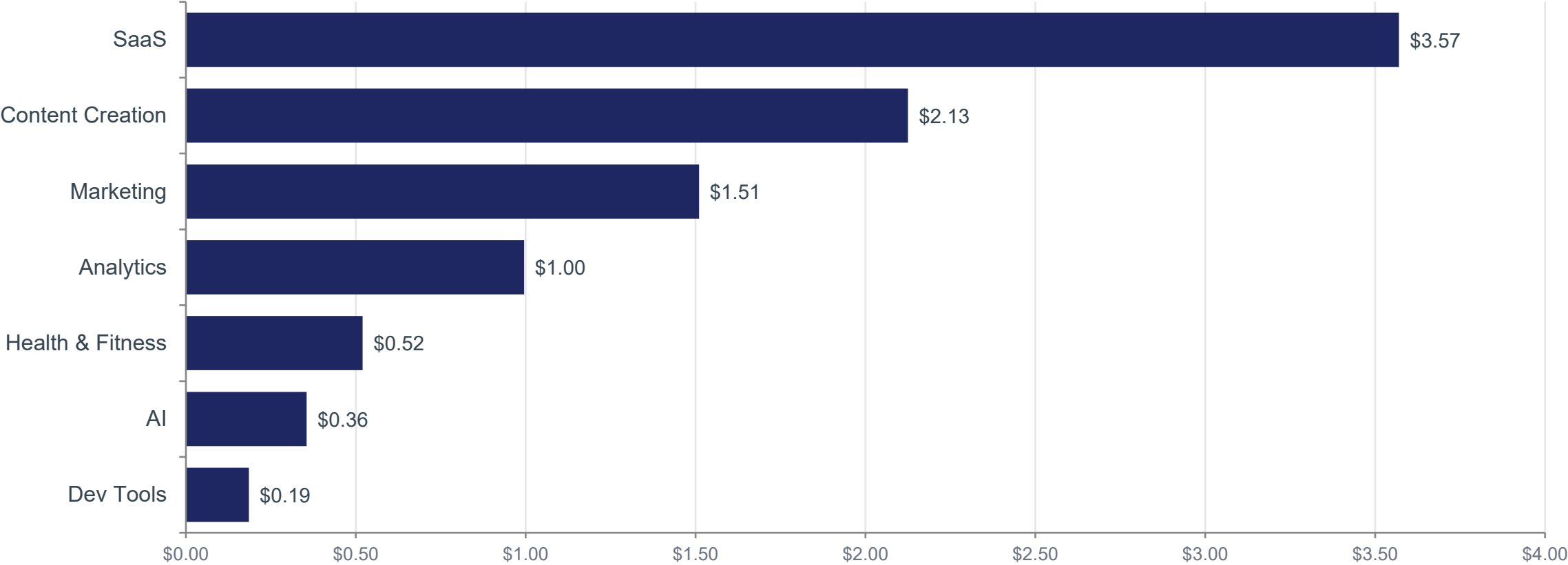
197 vs 30

AI has 197 startups chasing a median of \$446/mo. Education has just 30 — and a median of \$2,141/mo.

That's 4.8x more revenue per startup in a category with 6.6x fewer players.

Traffic isn't the bottleneck — conversion is

Median revenue earned per site visitor, by category (USD).

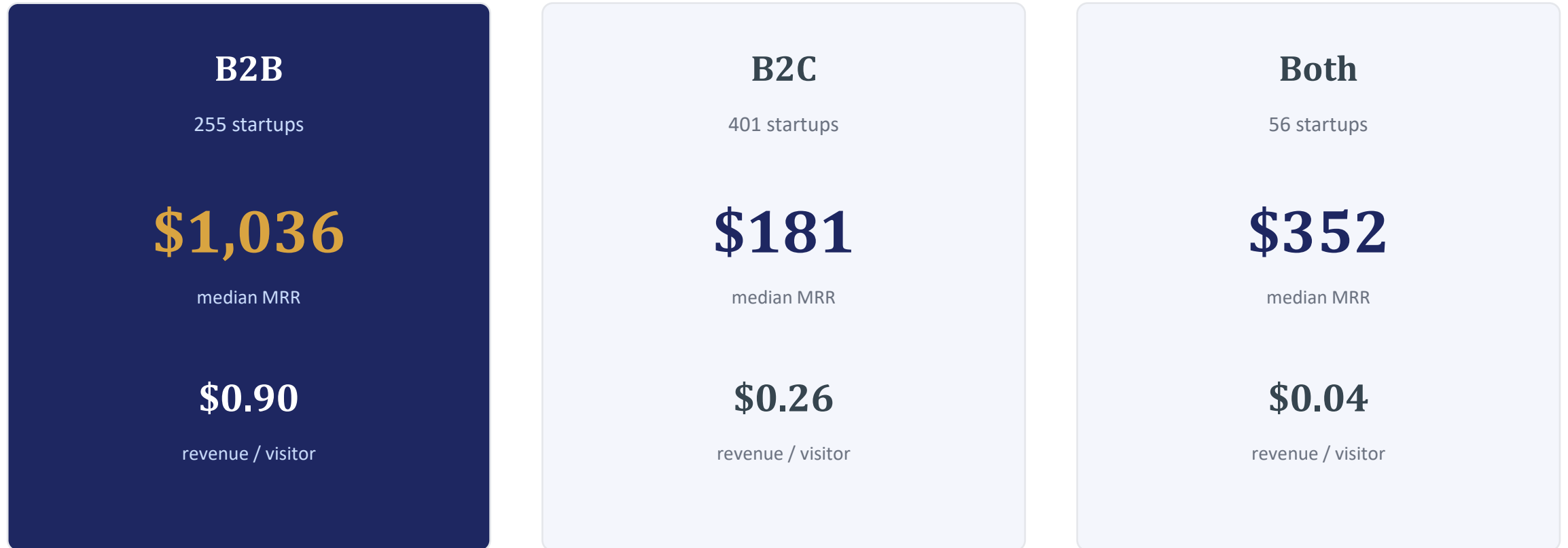


SaaS converts visitors into revenue at ~10x the rate of AI (\$3.57 vs \$0.36 per visitor) — fewer eyeballs needed to build a real business.

TrustMRR 1,000-row snapshot · revenue_per_visitor_usd, categories with n≥8

THE AUDIENCE CUT

B2B out-earns B2C on every measure that matters



A quarter of this dataset isn't building — it's exiting

262 of 1,000 startups (26.2%) are listed for sale on TrustMRR, at revenue multiples typically between 2x–10x MRR. This dataset isn't only a map of where startups are built — it's also a live secondary market for buying cash-flowing products instead of building from zero.

26.2%

of all startups are listed for sale

2x–10x

typical asking multiple on MRR

Where this analysis is weaker than it looks



27.4% of records have no category tag

Category-level conclusions are built on the 726 tagged records, not the full 1,000 — the untagged group could shift the picture.



"Stealth Company" entries recur across the dataset

Several of the highest-growth and highest-revenue rows are anonymized founders, so those specific outliers can't be traced or verified.



Growth-rate outliers are extreme (up to 12,983%)

Median, not mean, is used throughout — a handful of viral 30-day spikes would otherwise distort every category comparison.

Where the next startup should actually build

01

Build B2B, not B2C

5.7x higher median MRR, 3.5x higher revenue per visitor. The audience gap is the single strongest signal in the dataset.

02

Target under-crowded, high-value niches

Education and Analytics carry AI-beating median revenue with a fraction of the competitors — Marketing and Content Creation follow closely.

03

Treat AI as a distribution play, not a moat

197 competitors and a \$446 median MRR means the category rewards go-to-market execution, not the model itself.

THE THESIS

**AI is where founders are building.
B2B, Education, and SaaS are where the money is.**

The gap between the two is the opportunity.



Source: TrustMRR, 1,000-row snapshot, frozen 30 Jul 2026